IELTS WRITING MODULE

Complete Syllabus & Study Guide

1. Module Overview

The IELTS Writing test lasts **60 minutes** and consists of **two tasks**. Task 2 contributes twice as much to the final Writing band score as Task 1. Academic and General Training versions differ mainly in Task 1.

2. Key Facts at a Glance

3. Task Details

Academic Task 1

You are given a visual (line graph, bar chart, pie chart, table, process diagram, map or combination). You must summarise the main features, make comparisons where relevant, and report the information accurately. Do not give opinions or extra information not shown in the visual.

General Training Task 1

You write a letter in response to a given situation. The letter may be formal, semi-formal or informal depending on the context. You must cover all bullet points provided in the prompt and use an appropriate tone and style.

Task 2 (Both Versions)

You write a formal essay of at least 250 words. Common question types include: opinion (agree/disagree), discussion (both views), advantages/disadvantages, problem/solution, and two-part questions. You must present a clear position and support it with relevant examples.

4. Assessment Criteria (4 equally weighted)

5. Preparation Tips & Strategies

- Always plan before writing (2–3 minutes for Task 1, 5 minutes for Task 2).
- Stick to the recommended time allocation — Task 2 is more important.
- Meet the word count minimums; under-length answers are penalised.
- For Academic Task 1: focus on key trends, comparisons and significant data — avoid listing every number.
- For GT Task 1: cover every bullet point and match the required tone (formal/informal).
- For Task 2: have a clear thesis, well-developed paragraphs, and a logical conclusion.
- Practise under timed conditions and get feedback on all four criteria.
- Expand your range of linking words, academic vocabulary and complex sentence structures.

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